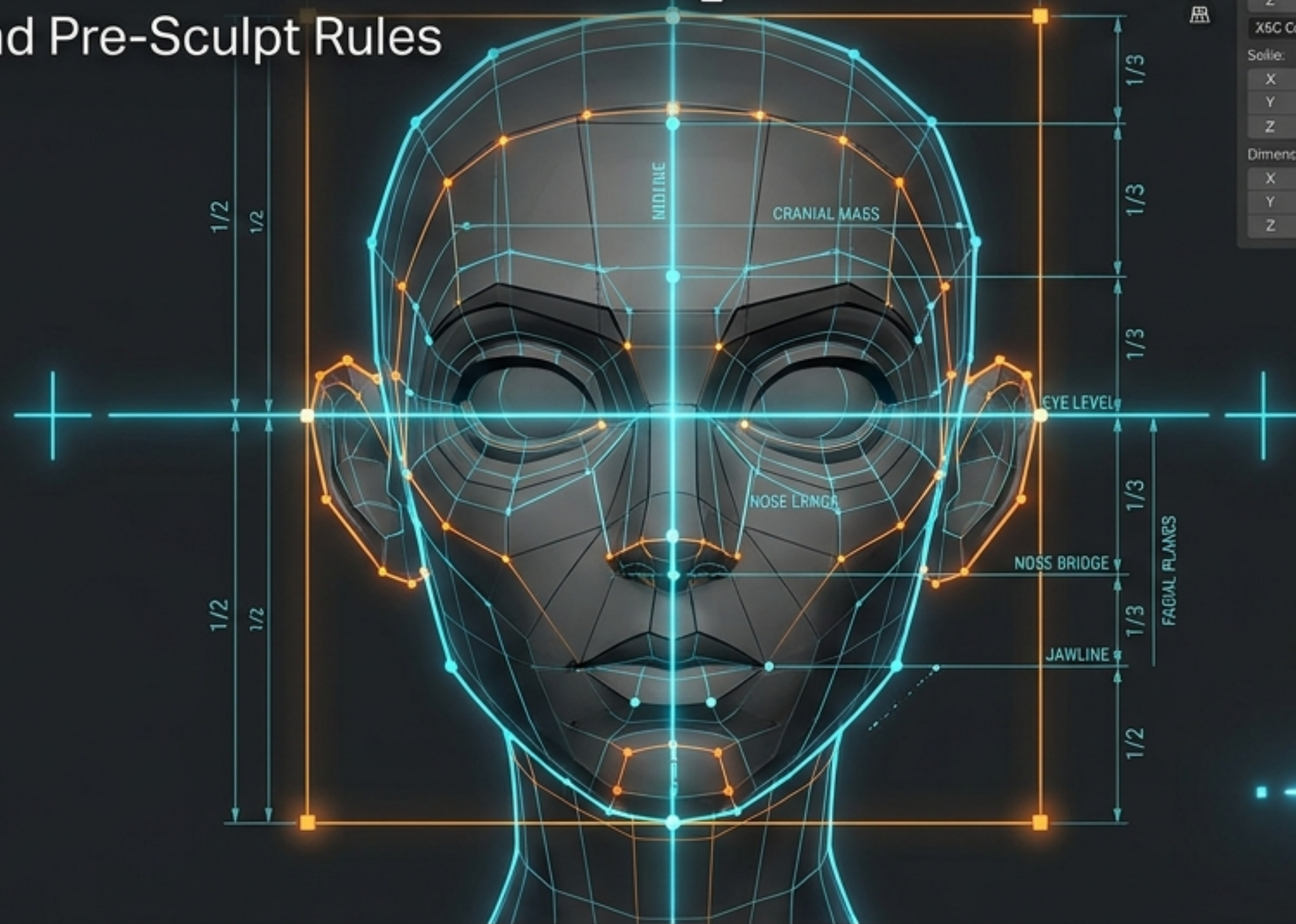


THE STYLIZED CHARACTER MASTERCLASS

The Fundamental Blueprint

Complete Theory, Proportions, and Pre-Sculpt Rules



Options

Transform

Location:

X	1m
Y	3m
Z	2m

Rotation:

X	0°
Y	0°
Z	0°

X5C Color

Scale:

X	3.000
Y	1.000
Z	1.000

Dimensions:

X	5.0m
Y	5.0m
Z	0.0m

The 8-Session Production Pipeline



1

**1. Concept
& Ref**
(Gathering the
blueprint.)

2

**2. Blockout
& Sculpt**
(Establishing
primitive forms.)

3

3. Retopology
(Creating clean
edge flow.)

4

**4. UV
Unwrapping**
(Preparing surfaces
for textures.)

5

**5. Hair
Grooming**
(Geometry Node
hair system.)

6

**6. Shading
& Texturing**
(Painting maps
and shaders.)

7

7. Rigging
(Generating the
skeleton.)

8

**8. Lighting
& Render**
(The final
turntable.)



Phase 1: Conceptual Foundation

A concept guides every 3D decision. Avoid overly complex, highly detailed character designs while learning the fundamentals.

Primary Concept



Targeted References

Face & Proportions

Structural guides for specific ethnic/stylistic features.



Clothing & Materials

Real-world physics of specific folds and fabrics.



Hair Details

Direction, volume, and separation of strands.



Prop Breakdown

Clear, multi-angle views of accessories.



Phase 2: Mastering the Blockout Philosophy

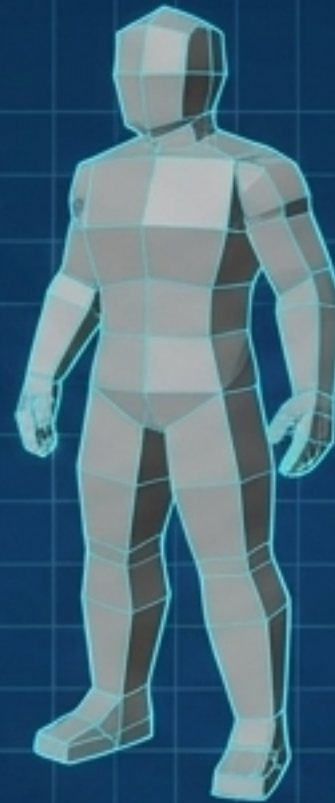
The blockout utilizes simple shapes to build the structural foundation. Ignore all fine details until the base structure is perfect.



1. Primitives

Divide and Conquer:

Break the character down into major primitive sections (Head, Torso, Arms, Legs).



2. Base Mesh

Shape Language:

Ensure consistency across forms (e.g., maintaining a purely boxy or purely rounded aesthetic).



3. Silhouette

Silhouette Diagnostic:

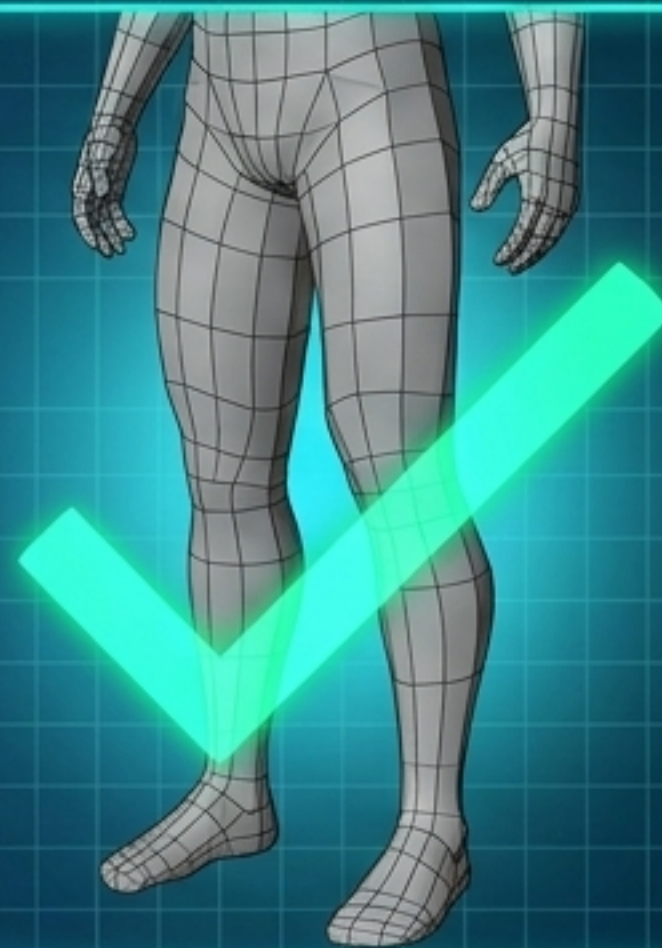
Switch the viewport to a pure black material to test readability from a distance.

Dynamic Forms: Straight vs. Curved Rhythms

Mixing straight and curved forms makes characters visually appealing and dynamic, eliminating robotic stiffness.



Parallel lines = Stiff, robotic, boring.



Upper Leg: Curved Front / Straight Back
Lower Leg: Straight Front / Curved Back

The Facial Proportion Matrix: Front View

Eye Line: Exactly $\frac{1}{2}$ way between the top of the cranium and the bottom of the jaw.

Brow Line: $\frac{1}{3}$ of the way down from the chosen hairline.

Nose Placement: Bottom of the nose sits $\frac{2}{3}$ down from the hairline (aligns with the bottom of the ear).

Mouth Placement: $\frac{1}{2}$ way between the bottom of the nose and the bottom of the jaw. Width corners must not go past the midpoint of the eyes (the iris).

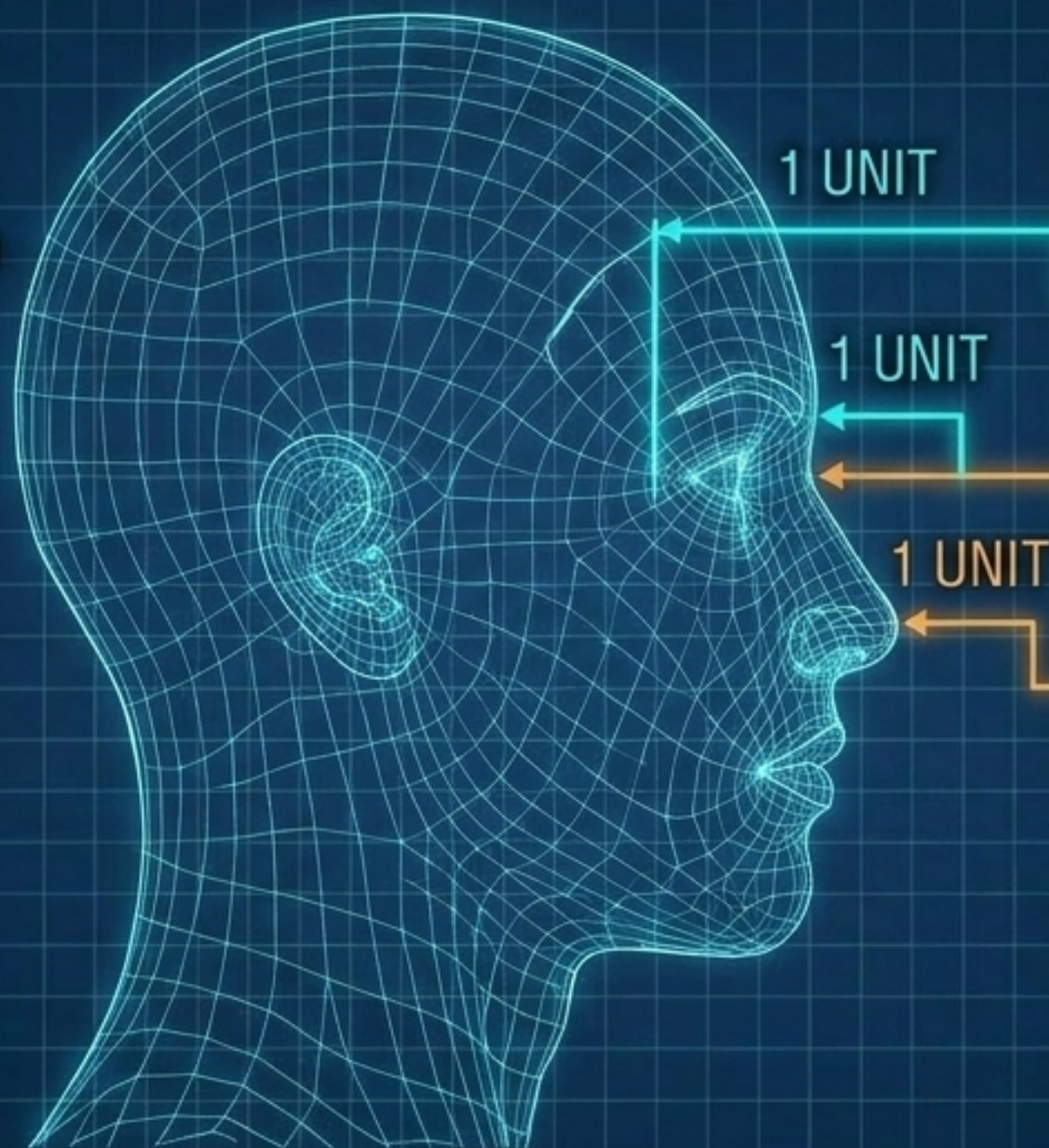
Eye Spacing: Eyes sit exactly one eye-width apart.



Mapping Facial Depth: Side Profile Proportions

The most common beginner error is sculpting a flat face.

Utilize the Rule of Thirds to establish correct facial depth.



Depth Unit 1: From the outer corner of the eye to the front edge of the eye.

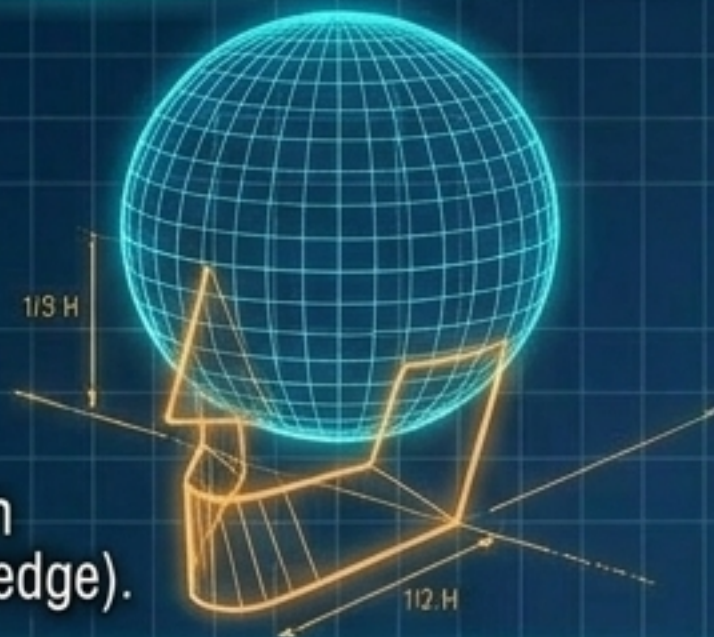
Depth Unit 2: From the front edge of the eye to the bridge of the nose.

Depth Unit 3: From the bridge of the nose to the tip of the nose.

Simplifying Complex Organic Features

The Head Structure:

Constructed from a Cranium (sphere) + Jaw (attached wedge).



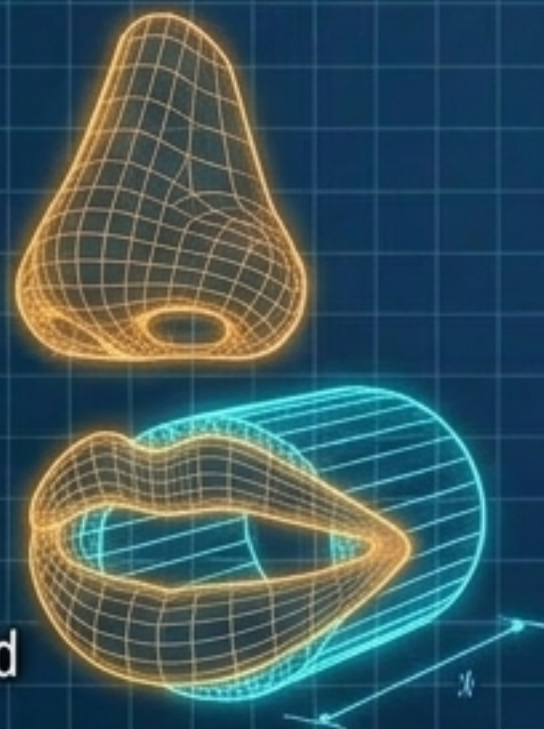
The Eyelids: Eyelids are not flat; they wrap around a spherical eyeball. Sculpt 3 distinct edges: Eyeball contact edge, eyelid fold, and face transition edge.



The Nose & Mouth:

Nose = A rounded triangular block.

Mouth = A 3D form wrapping around a cylindrical teeth structure.

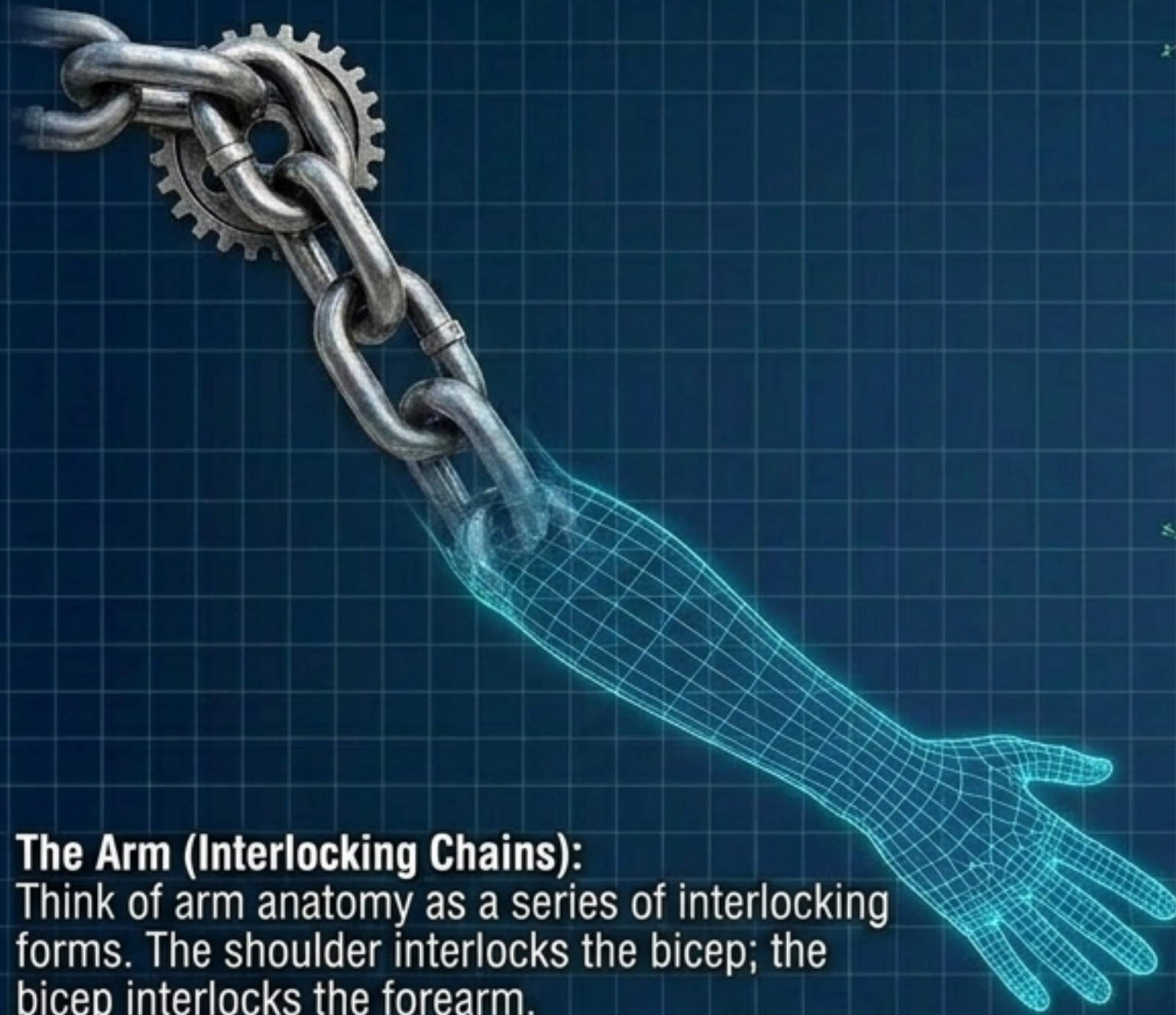


The Ear Anatomy:

Top/Front view = A wedge attached to the head. Inner details = A "Question Mark" rim wrapping around an internal "Y" shape.



Mental Models for Body Anatomy



The Arm (Interlocking Chains):

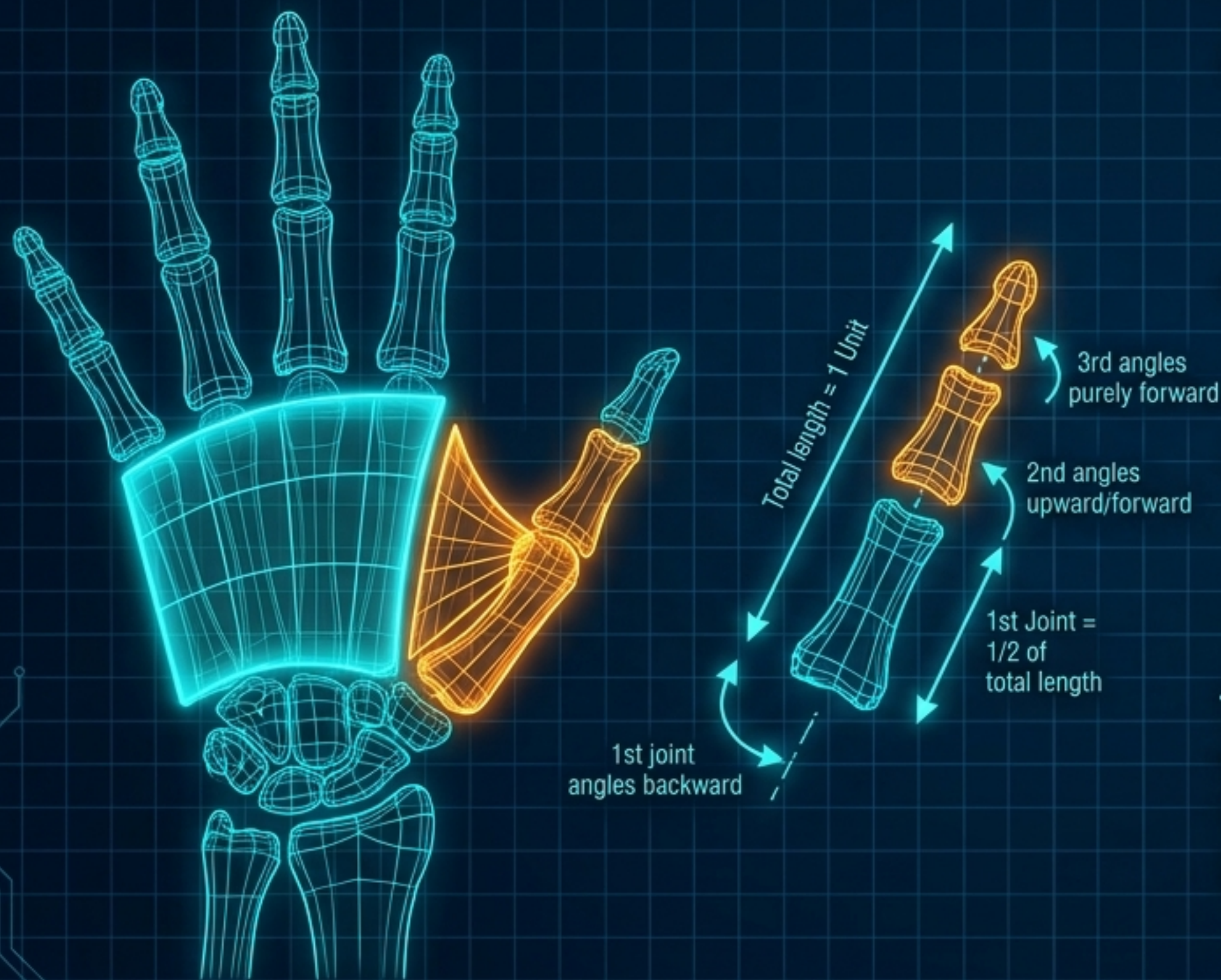
Think of arm anatomy as a series of interlocking forms. The shoulder interlocks the bicep; the bicep interlocks the forearm. Avoid stacking shapes directly on top of each other.



The Lower Leg (The Angry Face):

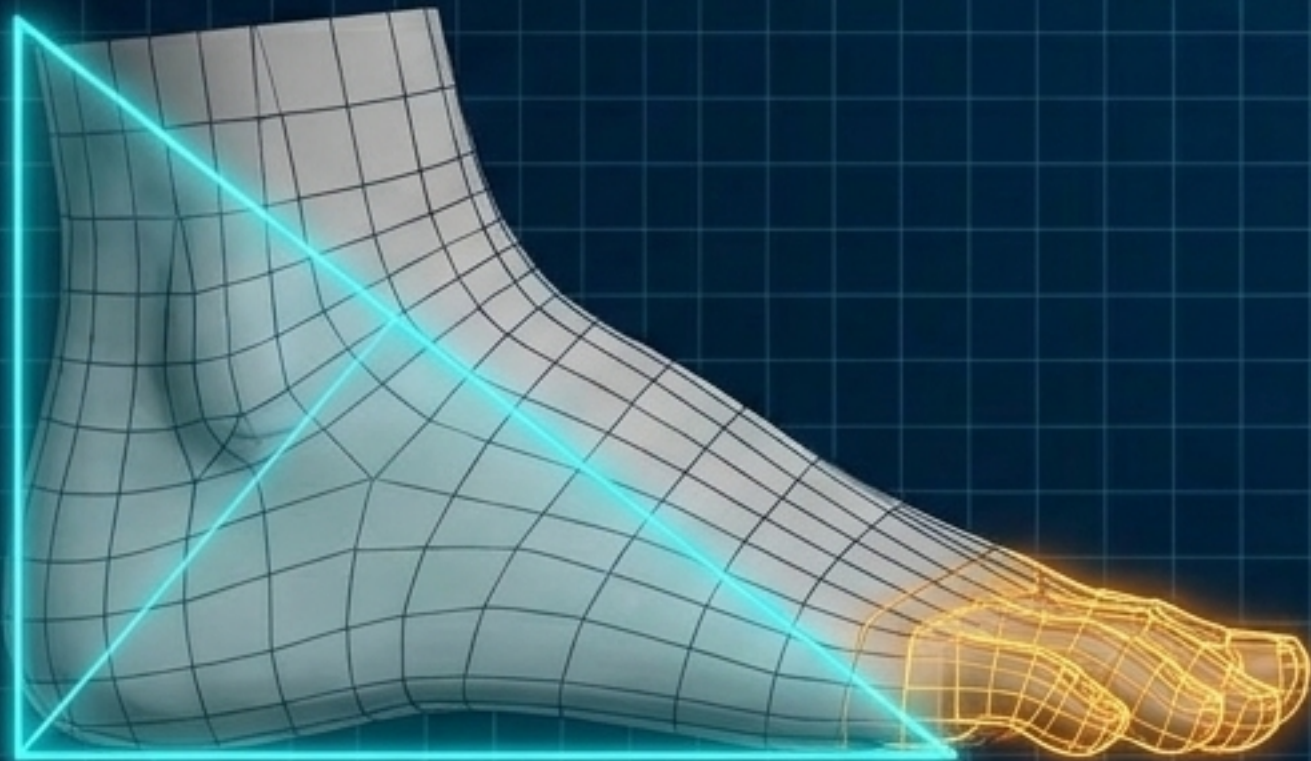
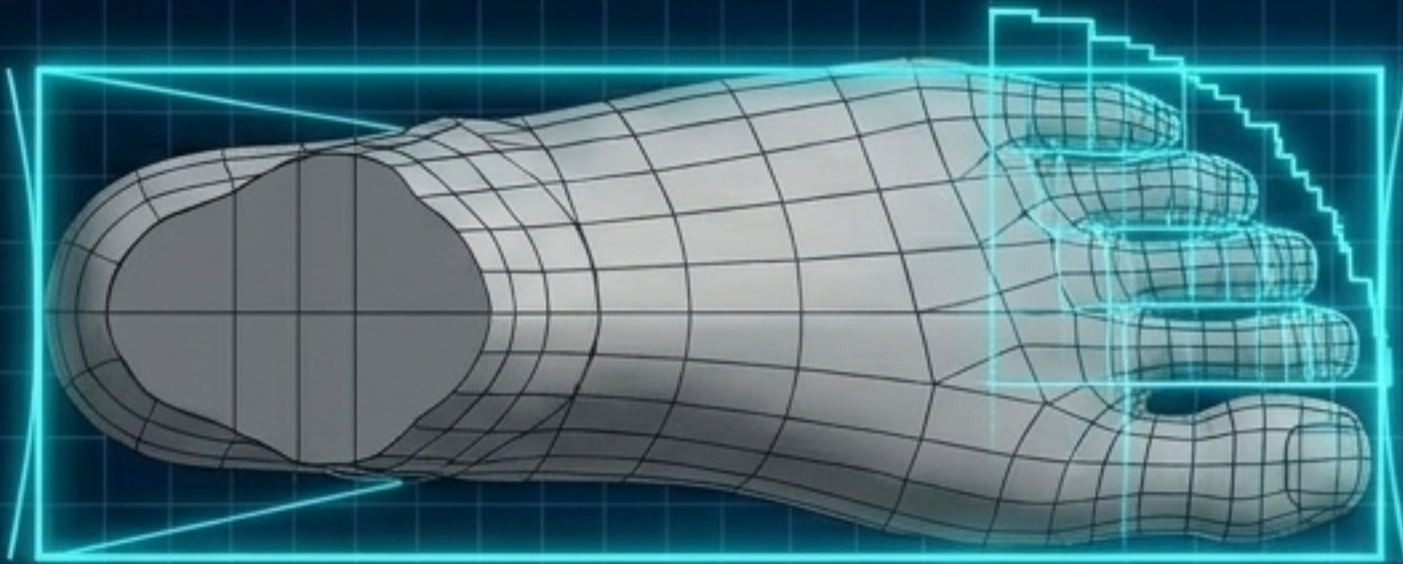
Visualize an angry face over the lower leg to lock in correct proportions.
The Eyes: Represent the calves (Inner calf always sits higher).
The Mouth: Dictates the ankles (Inner ankle always sits higher than the outer ankle).

The Structural Blueprint of the Hand



- The Palm Base: A rectangular shape with a wedge attached for the thumb. It is never perfectly flat; it maintains a natural curve.
- The Knuckle Arc: Knuckles sit on a curved arc, not a straight horizontal line.
- Finger Proportions: Total length (Knuckle to Tip) = 1 Unit.
1st Joint = $\frac{1}{2}$ of total length.
2nd Joint = $\frac{1}{2}$ of the remaining length.
- Joint Flow Angles: Fingers are not straight cylinders. The 1st joint angles backward, the 2nd angles upward/forward, and the 3rd angles purely forward.

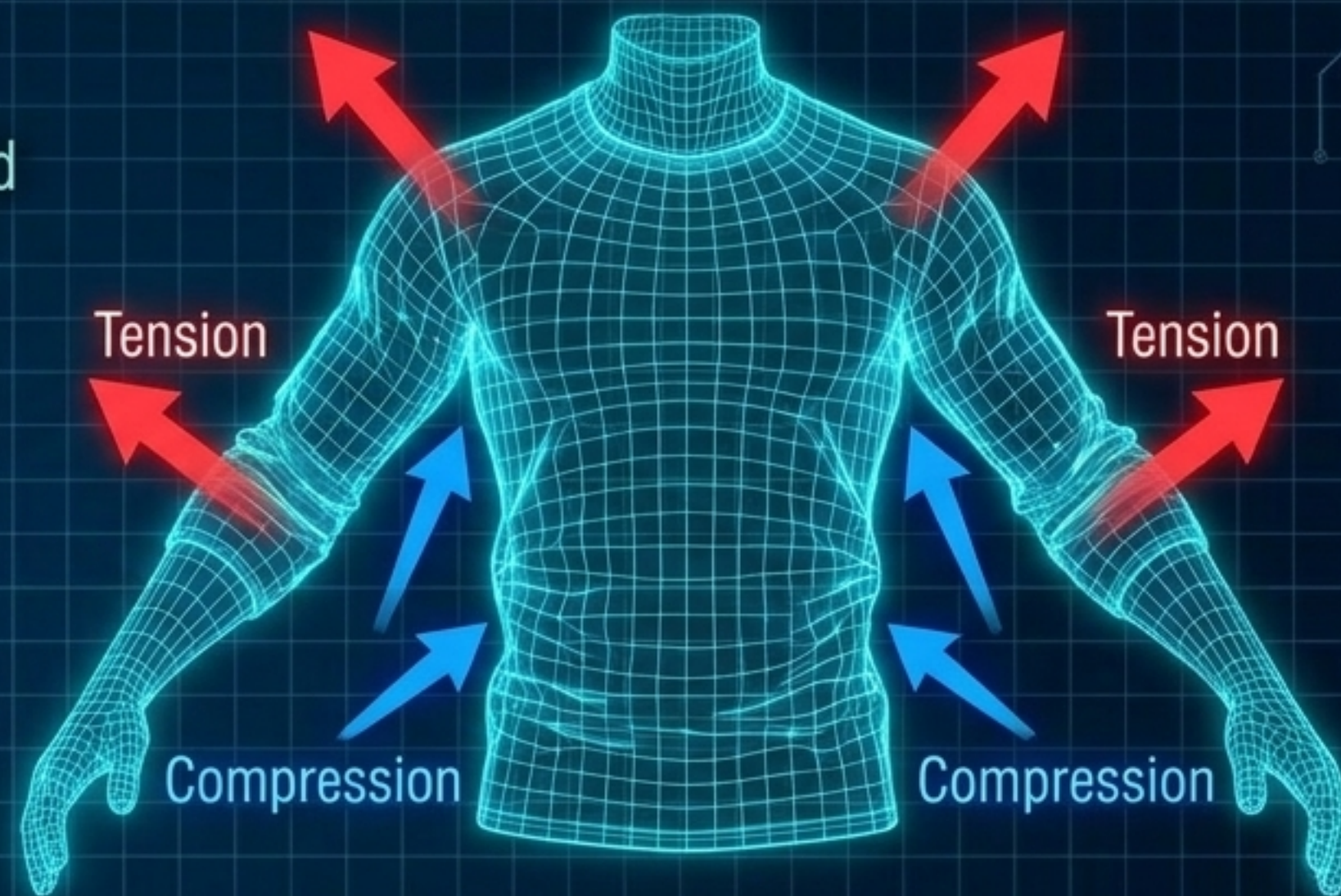
Geometric Construction of the Foot



- Front & Side Silhouette: Simplify the main mass into a right-angle triangle attached to the lower leg.
- Bottom Structure: Start with a basic rectangle, slightly pushed in on the sides to establish the footprint.
- Side Refinement: The midsection pushes upward and inward from the bottom to form the natural foot arch.
- Stepped Toes: Angle the toes in a 'stepped' downward arc to create a gradual, organic transition into the rest of the foot mass.

The Physics of Clothing Folds

Clothing behaves exactly like water—it perfectly conforms to the structure beneath it. Folds are dictated purely by the forces acting on the fabric.



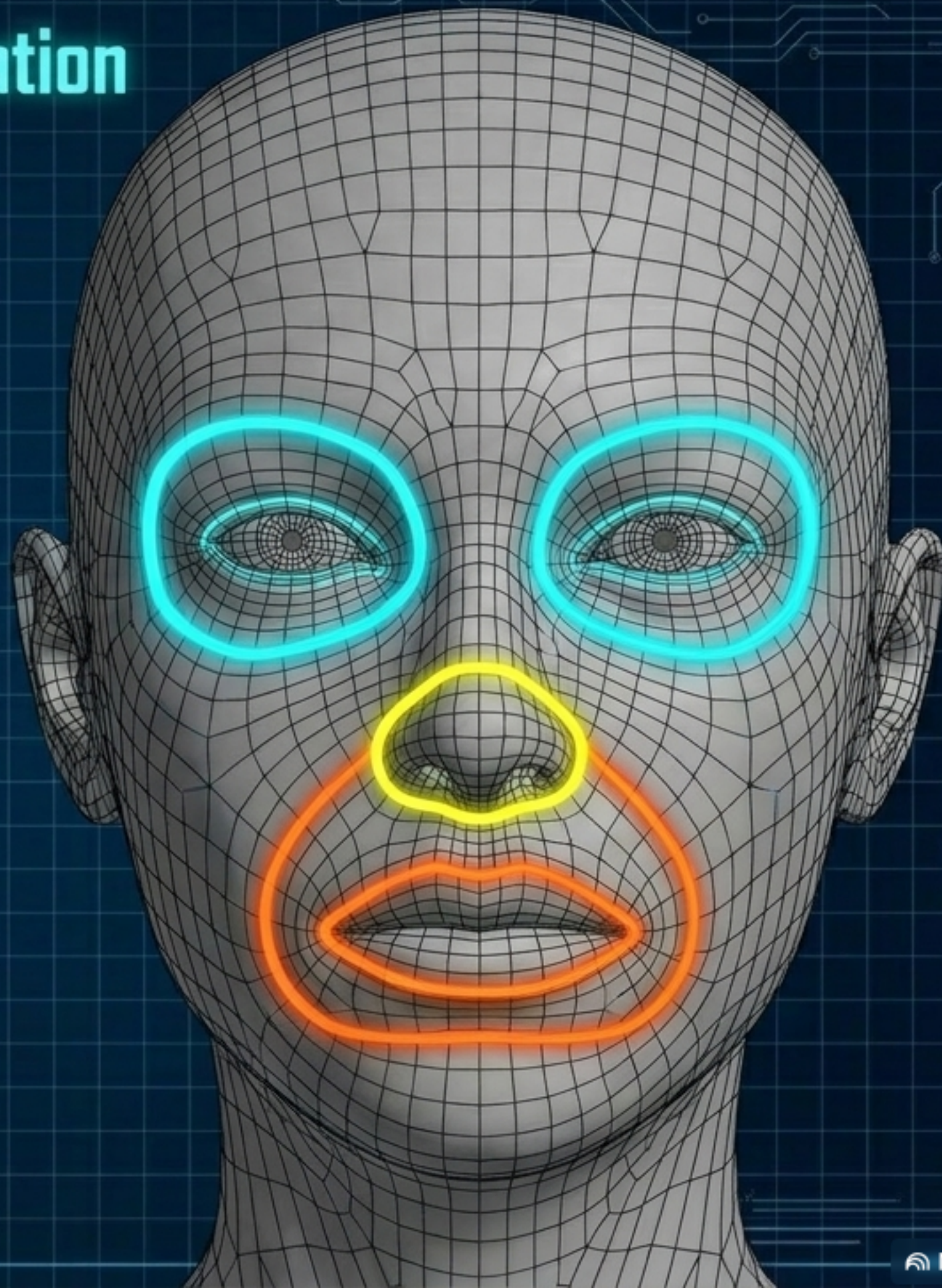
Tension Points (Pulling): Areas pulling the fabric taught (shoulders, elbows, knees). These create straight, radiating lines (Pipe, Drop, and Diaper folds).

Compression Points (Pushing): Areas pushing fabric into itself (bent joints, gathered waists, gravity). These create bunching and overlap (Zigzag, Spiral, and Half-lock folds).

Core Topology Loops for Clean Deformation

Retopology isn't just about reducing poly counts; it ensures clean deformation during rigging and animation. Edge loops must trace the natural muscles of the face.

- **Eye Loops (Cyan):** Critical support for eyelids closing and blinking without geometry tearing.
- **Muzzle Loops (Orange):** Radiates from the lips upward to the nose to support smiling, talking, and complex jaw movement.
- **Nose Loops (Yellow):** Controls nostril deformation without breaking the flow of the surrounding cheek geometry.



A Realistic 3-Month Production Timeline

Creating a character from scratch is a marathon.
Do not rush the blockout or fundamental phases.



Duration: The masterclass contains over 20 hours of raw procedural content.

Pacing: Treat each of the 13 chapters as one full week of work.

Goal: Expect a strict 3-month timeline if this is your first 3D character. Trust the process, respect the fundamentals, and execute session by session.